Board 1
South Deals
None Vul

♠ Q 7 3
♥ K 10 3
♦ K 10 4
♣ A Q 10 2

♠ 9 4
♥ 2
♦ Q 8 3 2
♣ J 8 7 6 5 3

♠ A 6 5 2
♥ A 8 7 5 4
♦ J 9 7
♣ 4

♠ K J 10 8
♥ Q J 9 6
♦ A 6 5
♣ K 9

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♦
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			

3NT by North
Lead: ♥5

You dealt this hand.

This is the one situation when you open a 3-card ♦ suit; two 4-card Majors, three ♦s and two ♣s, but not enough strength to open 1NT.

Partner responds 2NT.

Partner's bid shows 13-16 points, balanced. And most importantly, it denies holding a 4-card Major suit. So you do not consider bidding either your ♥s or ♠s, but just bid 3NT.

Board 2
South Deals
None Vul

♠ A J 3
♥ J 6 4
♦ 9 3
♣ K 10 9 8 5

♠ Q 9 5 2
♥ A Q 8 5
♦ K J 7
♣ 7 3

♠ K 10 7 4
♥ K 9 7 3
♦ 8 4 2
♣ 6 4

♠ 8 6
♥ 10 2
♦ A Q 10 6 5
♣ A Q J 2

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♦
Pass	1NT	Pass	2♣
Pass	3♣		
All Pass			

3♣ by South
Lead: ♠5

You dealt this hand.

With a 5-card and a 4-card Minor you open the 5-card. Partner responds 1NT.

With only 14 points a pass might be the best bid. But with doubletons in both Majors, knowing partner does not have 4 of either, you elect to bid 2♣. Partner now surprises you and bids 3♣. It's your bid.

Partner evidently found some hidden treasure when he revalued! But you still have only 16 points at the most so you pass.

Board 3
North Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ K Q 6 5 ♥ A K 9 7 ♦ 8 ♣ A Q J 2	
♠ A 9 8 2 ♥ 10 6 3 ♦ J 10 9 4 ♣ 5 4		♠ 10 7 3 ♥ 8 5 2 ♦ K 7 6 3 2 ♣ 9 6
	♠ J 4 ♥ Q J 4 ♦ A Q 5 ♣ K 10 8 7 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♣	Pass	3♣
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♦[2]
Pass	6♣		
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace

6♣ by North
Lead: ♠3

You dealt this hand.

Nice hand! But not strong enough to open with anything other than 1♣. Partner jumps to 3♣!

You might be tempted to mention one of your Majors at this point, but resist the temptation. Trust that your partner also knows the bidding priorities and that he would have bid a 4-card Major if he had held one. The problem with you now saying 3♥ for example, is that partner would probably think you had a 5-card ♥ suit and support you with only 3 of them. You know that ♣s is your suit so stick to it.

With partner showing 13-16 points, and your hand revaluing to 21 you are definitely thinking slam. It would not be terrible to just bid 6♣ right now, but Blackwood was invented just for these situations, to make sure you are not missing 2 Aces when you bid a slam. So you bid 4NT. Partner answers with 5♦. What say you?

Blackwood did its job. You are missing one Ace so all thoughts of a Grand are put aside. Bid 6♣.

Board 4
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ A J ♥ Q 7 3 ♦ K Q 10 6 2 ♣ 10 9 2	
♠ 9 7 6 ♥ K 10 6 4 2 ♦ A ♣ 7 6 4 3		♠ K 8 4 3 2 ♥ 8 5 ♦ 9 5 4 ♣ K J 8
	♠ Q 10 5 ♥ A J 9 ♦ J 8 7 3 ♣ A Q 5	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♦
Pass	3♦	Pass	3NT
All Pass			

3NT by South
Lead: ♥4

You dealt this hand.

This would be a perfect hand to open 1NT - well, it would be if it held one more point. But with only 14 you open your 4-card Minor, 1♦. Partner responds 3♦.

Partner suggests that ♦s is your suit, and he may be right. But you would much rather play the less demanding Notrump game if he is willing. So you bid 3NT, knowing that if partner is really distributional he will take you back to ♦s. He doesn't, so you play 3NT.